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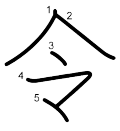
漢字 1: Command (令)

令		

Command. Order.

This 漢字 is also used as an honorific prefix in certain compounds.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	亼 + 卩
English	Assembly/Gathering + Seal/Stamp

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Command the ⌈assembly⌋ to give their ⌈stamp⌋ of approval.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**レイ (REI)**	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Command the ⟨**RAIN**⟩ to stop.

+ Words and Compounds

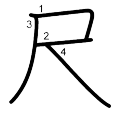
Example	English	Pronunciation
指令	finger + command = *order; directive*	シ·レイ (SHI·REI)
令和	order + harmony = *Reiwa Era (2019/05/01—...)*	レイ·ワ (REI·WA)
令達	order + achieve (reach) = *delivered order*	レイタツ (REI·TATSU)
令名	order + name (noted) = *fame*	レイ·メイ (REI·MEI)
令夫人	order + wife = *Mrs; Lady; your wife*	レイ·フ·ジン (REI·FU·JIN)
令兄	order + elder brother = *your elder brother*	レイ·ケイ (REI·KEI)
号令	title + command = *command; order*	ゴウ·レイ (GŌ·REI)

{···} Sample Sentence

私	の	命令	は	絶対	だ。
わたし	の	メイレイ	は	ゼッタイ	だ
I	の	orders	は	absolute	be/is

My orders are absolute.

漢字 2: Measurement (尺)

尺		

Measurement. 30.3 cm.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	丶 + 尸
English	Dot + Corpse/Body

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Measure the ⌈dot⌋ on the ⌈corpse⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**シャク (SHAKU)**	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Measure with a ⟨**SHAKUHACHI**⟩.

+ Words and Compounds

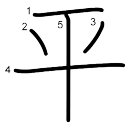
Example	English	Pronunciation
尺八	measurement + eight = *shakuhachi flute*	シャク·ハチ (SHAKU·HACHI)
尺骨	30.3 cm + bone = *Ulna*	シャッ·コツ (SHAK·KOTSU)
尺地	measurement + ground = *small land plot*	シャク·チ (SHAKU·CHI)
尺寸	measurement + tiny = *sth. tiny; trifle*	シャク·スン (SHAKU·SUN)
尺度	measurement + degree = *linear measure; scale*	シャク·ド (SHAKU·DO)

{···} Sample Sentence

人	は	万物	の	尺度	で	ある。
ひと	は	バンブツ	の	シャクド	で	ある
person	は	creation	の	scale	で	ある

Man is the measure of all things.

漢字 3: Flat (平)

平		

Flat.

Extended meanings such as *ordinary* and *peaceful*.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	艹 + 干
English	Grass/Herb/Plant + Dry

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Flat, ⌈dried⌋ ⌈herbs⌋ by putting flat books on them.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**ヘイ (HEI)**	**ひら (hira)**
ヘイ is the more common of these readings.		
L.C.	ビョウ (BYŌ)	たい (tai)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The flats ≺**he rustled**≻ went ⟨**HAYWIRE**⟩.

Flats in ≺Tailand≻ will ⟨BE YOURS⟩.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
平たい	*flat; level*	ひら·たい (hira·tai)
平和	flat + harmony = *peace*	ヘイ·ワ (HEI·WA)
太平洋	fat + flat + ocean = *the Pacific Ocean*	タイ·ヘイ·ヨウ (TAI·HEI·YŌ)
平日	flat + sun (day) = *weekday*	ヘイ·ジツ (HEI·JITSU)
平気	flat + spirit = *all right; OK*	ヘイ·キ (HEI·KI)
平服	flat + clothes = *ordinary clothes*	ヘイ·フク (HEI·FUKU)
平手	flat + hand = *palm; open hand*	ひら·て (hira·te)
平和運動	peace + exercise = *peace movement*	ヘイ·ワ·ウン·ドウ (HEI·WA·UN·DŌ)
平泳ぎ	flat + swim = *breaststroke*	ひら·およ·ぎ (hira·oyo·gi)

{···} Sample Sentence

平和	は	とても	大切	です。
ヘイワ	は	とても	タイセツ	です
peace	は	very	important	be/is

Peace is of great importance.

漢字 4: Degree (度)

度		

Degree. Extent.

This 漢字 can also mean *times* in the sense of *how many times*.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	广 + 廿 + 又
English	Slanted Roof + Twenty + Again

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The extent of the ⌈slanted roof⌋ making a ⌈20⌋ degree angle ⌈again⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**ド (DO)**	**たび (tabi)**
L.C.	タク、ト (TAKU, TO)	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The extent of ≺**tubby**≻ ⟨**DOTS**⟩ ⟨TUCKED⟩ at the ⟨TOP⟩.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
度する (tr.)	*to redeem (from sin); to save*	ド·する (DO·suru)
度合い	degree + match = *degree; extent*	ド·あ·い (DO·a·i)
度々	degree + degree = *often; over and over*	たび·たび (tabi·tabi)
一度	one + degree (times) = *once; one time*	イチ·ド (ICHI·DO)
丁度	block + degree = *exactly*	チョウ·ド (CHŌ·DO)
*度外れ	degree + outside = *extraordinary; excessive*	ド·はず·れ DO·hazu·re
度数	degree + number = *frequency; incidence*	ド·スウ (DO·SŪ)
度し難い	degree + difficult = *beyond help*	ど·し·がた·い (do·shi·gata·i)

{···} Sample Sentence

さあ、	もう一度。
さあ	もうイチド
come now	once more

Come on, try again.

漢字 5: Edge (際)

際	際	

Edge. Limit.

A secondary meaning has to do with *occasion*.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	阝 阜 + 祭
English	Hill/Mound + Festival (**??**)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

At the edge of the ⌈hill⌋ is a ⌈festival⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**サイ (SAI)**	**きわ (kiwa)**

The 訓読み is always voice outside the first position with the exception of 一際 (hito·kiwa/ひと·きわ), *remarkably, conspicuous*; recall from Entry **??** that no 漢字 becomes voiced following 一 when it is read as ひと.

L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Edgy ⟨**PSYCHO**⟩ ≺**key-warden**≻.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
際どい	*risky; questionable*	きわ·どい (kiwa·doi)
際して	*when*	サイ·して (SAI·shite)
際会	edge + meet = *meeting; facing*	サイ·カイ (SAI·KAI)
水際	water + edge = *water's edge; waterside*	みず·ぎわ (mizu·giwa)
国際	country + edge = *international*	コク·サイ (KOKU·SAI)
際立つ	edge + stand = *to be prominent / conspicuous*	きわ·だ·つ (kiwa·da·tsu)
実際	actual + edge = *in practice; in actuality*	ジッ·サイ (JIS·SAI)
際物	edge + thing = *seasonal goods*	きわ·もの (kiwa·mono)

{···} Sample Sentence

英語	は	国際語	に	成った。
エイゴ	は	コクサイゴ	に	なった
English	は	international language	に	to become

English has become an international language.

漢字 6: Lend (貸)

貸	貸	

Lend.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	代 + 貝
English	Substitute (**??**) + Shellfish

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Lending ⌈shellfish⌋ to the ⌈substitute⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	**か (ka)**

This reading is frequently voiced when not in the first position.

L.C.	タイ (TAI)	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Lending to ≺**customers**≻ is really a ⟨TIGHT⟩ spot.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
This 漢字 can absorb its ひらがな accompaniment when forming compounds.		
貸す	*lend*	か·す (ka·su)
貸付	lend + attach = *loan*	だし·つけ (kashi·tsuke)
貸切	lend + cut = *reserved; chartered*	かし·きり (kashi·kiri)
貸主	lend + primary = *lender; landlord*	かし·ぬし (kashi·nushi)
貸家	lend + house = *house for rent*	かし·や (kashi·ya)
貸元	lend + basis = *financier; lender*	かし·もと (kashi·moto)
貸本屋	lend + bookshop = *rental library*	かし·ホン·や (kashi·HON·ya)
貸自動車	lend + automatic + car = *rental car*	かし·ジ·ドウ·シャ (kashi·JI·DŌ·SHA)

{···} Sample Sentence

金	を	貸して	友	を	失え。
キン	を	かして	とも	を	うしなえ
gold	を	to lend	friend	を	to lose

Lend your money and lose your friend.

漢字 7: Taste (味)

味 味

Taste. Flavour.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	口 + 未
English	Mouth + Not Yet (**??**)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The tastes of ⌈vampires⌋ have ⌈not yet⌋ been approved.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**ミ (MI)**	**あじ (aji)**
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Tasting ⟨**MITIGATED**⟩ by ≺**ajin**≻.

‡*Ajin* are demi-humans in the 'Ajin' アニメ series.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
味わう (tr.)	*to taste (sth.)*	あじ·わう (aji·wau)
味がする (tr.)	*to taste of (sth.)*	あじ·がする (aji·gasuru)
味わい知る (tr.)	*to taste and know (sth.)*	あじ·わい·し·る (aji·wai·shi·ru)
味な	*smart; clever; witty*	あじ·な (aji·na)
気味	spirit + taste = *feeling/sensation*	キ·ミ (KI·MI)
味気ない	taste + spirit = *wearisome; dull; wretched; vain*	あじ·ケ·ない (aji·KE·nai)
意味	mind + taste = *meaning; significance*	イ·ミ (I·MI)
味方	taste + direction = *friend; ally*	ミ·かた (MI·kata)

**** Irregular Reading(s)**

Example	English	Pronunciation
美味しい	beautiful + taste = *delicious*	おい·しい (oi·shii)

{···} Sample Sentence

彼女	の	その	問題	の	説明	は	無意味	だった。
かのジョ	の	その	モンダイ	の	セツメイ	は	ムイミ	だった
she/her	の	that	problem	の	explanation	は	meaningless	be/is

Her explanation of the problem added up to the nonsense.

漢字 8: Field (野)

野 野

Field. The wild.

Interestingly, this 漢字 is used to denote a *political party in opposition*.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	里 + 予
English	Hamlet + Beforehand (**??**)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Fields in the ⌈hamlet⌋ must be watered ⌈beforehand⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**ヤ (YA)**	**の (no)**

Both readings will be encountered frequently, although ヤ appears more often in the second position.

L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

In the wild ⟨**YACHTING**⟩ with the ≺**nobs**≻.

‡*Nob* is a person of wealth or high social position.

+ Words and Compounds

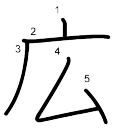
Example	English	Pronunciation
野心	field + heart = *ambition*	ヤ·シン (YA·SHIN)
分野	part + field = *field (of study, etc.)*	ブン·ヤ (BUN·YA)
野山	field + mountain = *hills and fields*	の·やま (no·yama)
野生動物	field + life + animal = *wild animal*	ヤ·セイ·ドウ·ブツ (YA·SEI·DŌ·BUTSU)
野性	field + nature = *uncouth; rough*	ヤ·セイ (YA·SEI)
野原	field + original = *field(s)*	no·hara (の·はら)

{···} Sample Sentence

彼	は	大変	な	野心家	だった。
かれ	は	タイヘン	な	ヤシンカ	だった
he	は	immense	な	ambitious person	だった

He was a man of great ambition.

漢字 9: Wide (広)

広		

Wide. Broad. Spacious.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	广 + 厶
English	Slanted roof + Self/Private

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Wide 「slanted roofs」 are for 「private」 use, broadly speaking.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**コウ (KŌ)**	**ひろ (hiro)**
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Wide open, ≺**Hiroshima**≻ was its own ⟨**CAUSE**⟩ of defeat.

+ Words and Compounds

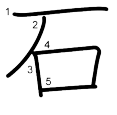
Example	English	Pronunciation
広がる (intr.)	*to spread (out)*	ひろ·がる (hiro·garu)
広げる (tr.)	*to spread (sth.)*	ひろ·げる (hiro·geru)
広間	wide + interval (room) = *hall; saloon*	ひろ·ま (hiro·ma)
広い	*wide; spacious*	ひろ·い (hiro·i)
広島	wide + island = *Hiroshima*	ひろ·しま (hiro·shima)
広大	wide + large = *extensive; immense*	コウ·ダイ (KŌ·DAI)
広言	wide + speak = *boasting*	コウ·ゲン (KŌ·GEN)

{···} Sample Sentence

その	川	は	広い。
その	かわ	は	ひろい
that/the	river	は	wide

The river is wide.

漢字 10: Stone (石)

石		

Stone.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	石
English	Stone/Rock

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Part of the 漢字 radicals (#112).

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**セキ (SEKI)**	**いし (ishi)**
セキ is more common outside of the first position.		
L.C.	シャク、コク (SHAKU, KOKU)	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The stone -colored ≺**Ishihara**≻ test that ⟨COCKED⟩ my interest was ⟨SHOCKINGLY⟩ ⟨**SEXY**⟩.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
石	*stone*	いし (ishi)
化石	change + stone = *fossil*	カ·セキ (KA·SEKI)
一石二鳥	one + stone + two + bird = *kill two birds with one stone*	イッ·セキ·ニ·チョウ (IS·SEKI·NI·CHŌ)
石英	stone + brilliance = *quartz*	セキ·エイ (SEKI·EI)
石頭	stone + head = *obstinate person; stubbornness*	いし·あたま (ishi·atama)
石川県	stone + river + prefecture = *Ishikawa prefecture*	いし·かわ·ケン (ishi·kawa·KEN)
石室	stone + room = *stone hut; tomb*	セキ·シツ (SEKI·SHITSU)

{···} Sample Sentence

橋	は	石造り	だ。
はし	は	いしづくり	だ
bridge	は	made of stone	だ

The bridge is made of stone.

漢字 11: China (漢)

漢

China. The Han Dynasty.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	水氵 氷 + 艹 + 口 + 夫
English	Water + Grass/Herb/Plant + Mouth + Husband (**??**)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Chinese ⌈vampire⌋ ⌈husbands⌋ drink ⌈water⌋ mixed with ⌈herbs⌋.

Chinese ⌈water⌋ ⌈herbs⌋ are for ⌈vampire⌋ ⌈husbands⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**カン (KAN)**	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The Chinese are ⟨**CUNNING**⟩.

+ Words and Compounds

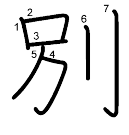
Example	English	Pronunciation
漢字	China + character = 漢字	カン·ジ (KAN·JI)
漢方	China + direction = *Chinese medicine*	カン·ポウ (KAN·PŌ)
漢和	China + harmony = *China and Japan*	カン·ワ (KAN·WA)
漢民族	China + people + tribe = *Chinese people*	カン·ミン·ゾク (KAN·MIN·ZOKU)
漢人	China + person = *Chinese person*	カン·ジン (KAN·JIN)
漢土	China + earth = *China*	カン·ド (KAN·DO)
漢字試験	Kanji + test = *Kanji test*	カン·ジ·シ·ケン (KAN·JI·SHI·KEN)

{···} Sample Sentence

この	漢字	は	どういう	意味	です	か。
この	カンジ	は	どういう	イミ	です	か
this	Kanji	は	what kind of	meaning	be/is	か

What does this kanji mean?

漢字 12: Different (別)

別 

Different.

The ideas of *separation* and *farewell*.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	口 + 勹 + 刂刀刀ク
English	Mouth + Embracing/Wrap + Knife/Sword

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Different ⌈vampires⌋ ⌈embraced⌋ the idea of a ⌈sword⌋ farewell.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**ベツ (BETSU)**	**わか (waka)**
L.C.	—	わ (wa)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Different ≺wanderers≻ made ≺**wakaberry**≻ ⟨**BETS**⟩.

+ Words and Compounds

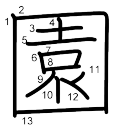
Example	English	Pronunciation
別に	*(not) particularly*	ベツ·に (BETSU·ni)
別れる	*part company; branch off*	わか·れる (waka·reru)
別々	different + different = *separate; individual*	ベツ·ベツ (BETSU·BETSU)
別物	different + thing = *another thing; exception*	ベツ·モノ (BETSU·MONO)
送別	send + different = *farewell; send-off*	ソウ·ベツ (SŌ·BETSU)
別名	different + name = *alias; pen name*	ベツ·メイ (BETSU·MEI)
別料金	different + fee = *extra cost / charge*	ベツ·リョウ·キン (BETSU·RYŌ·KIN)

{···} Sample Sentence

別々	に	払います。
ベツベツ	に	はらいます
separately	に	to pay

Please bill us separately.

漢字 13: Garden (園)

園		

Garden.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	口 + 土 + 口 + 衣衤
English	Prison/Enclosure + Earth/Soil + Mouth + Clothes
Long kimono | 袁 = 衣 + 口 + 土	

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The garden was a ⌈soil⌋ ⌈enclosure⌋ for ⌈clothed⌋ ⌈vampires⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**エン (EN)**	—
L.C.	—	その (sono)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Garden ⟨**ENTRANCE**⟩ graced with ≺sonorous≻ sounds.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
Recall from Entry **??** that the first two characters of the final compound mean *"animal"* when taken together.		
公園	public + garden = *park*	コウ·エン (KŌ·EN)
学園	study + garden = *educational institute*	ガク·エン (GAKU·EN)
動物園	animal + garden = *zoo*	ドウ·ブツ·エン (DŌ·BUTSU·EN)

{···} Sample Sentence

公園	で	降りました。
コウエン	で	おりました
park	で	descend
		I got off at the park.

漢字 14: All (皆)

皆		

All.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	比 + 白
English	Compare (**??**) + White

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

All ⌈white⌋ ⌈comparisons⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	**みな (mina)**
In spoken Japanese, this reading is often pronounced みんな (minna) for emphasis.		
L.C.	カイ (KAI)	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

All ≺**minatory**≻ ⟨KITES⟩.

‡Minatory expresses or conveys a threat.

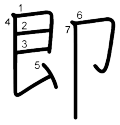
+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
皆	*all; everybody*	みな (mina)
皆様	all + manner = *"ladies and gentlemen"*	みな·さま (mina·sama)

{···} Sample Sentence

皆	幸せ	だ。
みんな	しあわせ	だ
everyone	happiness	be/is
		All are happy.

漢字 15: Immediate (即)

即		

Immediate. At once.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	卩 + 艮
English	Seal/Stamp + Boundary

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Immediately 「stop」 at the 「boundary」.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**ソク (SOKU)**	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Immediately , the ⟨**SOKKIE**⟩ came to an end.

+ Words and Compounds

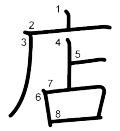
Example	English	Pronunciation
即日	immediate + sun (day) = *on the same day*	ソク·ジツ (SOKU·JITSU)
即死	immediate + death = *instant death*	ソク·シ (SOKU·SHI)
即売	immediate + sell = *sale on the spot*	ソク·バイ (SOKU·BAI)

{···} Sample Sentence

その	犬	は	即死した。
その	いぬ	は	ソクシした
that	dog	は	instant death

The dog was killed on the spot.

漢字 16: Shop (店)

店		

Shop. Store.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	广 + 占
English	Slanted Roof + Occupy

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Shops with 「slanted roofs」 are 「occupied」 by the American military.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**テン (TEN)**	**みせ (mise)**
テン is the more common reading.		
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The shop was filled with ⟨**TENSE**⟩ ≺**misery**≻.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
店	*shop; store*	みせ (mise)
開店	open + shop = *shop/store opening*	カイ·テン (KAI·TEN)
書店	write + shop = *bookstore*	ショ·テン (SHO·TEN)

{···} Sample Sentence

書店	で	手	に	入ります。
ショテン	で	て	に	はいります
bookstore	で	hand	に	to get in

You can get it at a bookstore.

漢字 17: Institution (院)

院		

Institution, in the sense of public buildings such as hospitals, or bodies such as legislatures.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	阝 阜 + 完
English	Hill/Mound + Perfect

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Institution 「perfectly」 situated on a 「hill」.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**イン (IN)**	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Institution for ⟨**INK**⟩.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
入院	enter + institution = *to be admitted to hospital*	ニュウ·イン (NYŪ·IN)
学院	study + institution = *academy*	ガク·イン (GAKU·IN)
病院	illness + institution = *hospital*	ビョウ·イン (BYŌ·IN)

{···} Sample Sentence

病院	は	ここ	から	近い。
ビョウイン	は	ここ	から	ちかい
hospital	は	here	from	near

The hospital is near here.

漢字 18: Climb (登)

登		

Climb.

An important secondary meaning has to do with attendance (the first compound offers an example).

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	癶 + 豆
English	Footsteps/Departure + Bean/A kind of a vessel

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Climb after your 「departure」 into a 「kind of a vessel」.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**トウ (TŌ)**	—
L.C.	ト (TO)	のぼ (nobo)

You are likely to encounter the 音読み in one word: 登山 (ト·ザン/TO·ZAN) *"mountain climbing"*, with 山 being voiced. The 訓読み for this 漢字 serves as an alternate form of 上る (のぼ·る/nobo·ru), which we met in Entry **??**.

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Climbing is ⟨**TORTURE**⟩ when there is ≺nobody≻ at the ⟨TOP⟩ to help you.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
登校	climb (attend) + school = *attend school*	トウ·コウ (TŌ·KŌ)
登場	climb + place = *make an entrance; show up*	トウ·ジョウ (TŌ·JŌ)

{···} Sample Sentence

登校する	所	です。
トウコウする	ところ	です
going to school	place	be/is

I am going to school.

漢字 19: Original (原)

原		

Original, in the sense of things in their "original or primitive state".

Many compounds with this character also convey the idea of a "plain or field" (the first two examples below, for instance). Think of this in connection to original as a place that is "unspoiled or wilderness-like".

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	厂 + 白 + 小
English	Cliff + White + Small

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The original ⌈white⌋, ⌈small⌋ ⌈cliff⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**ゲン (GEN)**	**はら (hara)**
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Originally, ⟨**GENGHIS-KHAN**⟩ committed ≺**hara-kiri**≻.

**** Irregular Reading(s)**

Example	English	Pronunciation
川原	river + original = *dry riverbed*	かわ·ら (kawa·ra)

+ Words and Compounds

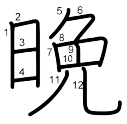
Example	English	Pronunciation
野原	field + original = *field(s)*	の·はら (no·hara)
高原	tall + original = *plateau; tableland*	コウ·ゲン (KŌ·GEN)
原子力	original + child + strength = *atomic energy; nuclear power*	ゲン·シ·リョク (GEN·SHI·RYOKU)

{···} Sample Sentence

野原	に	は	六	頭	の	羊	が	いた。
のはら	に	は	ロク	トウ	の	ひつじ	が	いた
field	に	は	six	counter for large animals	の	sheep	が	to be

There were six sheep in the field.

漢字 20: Late (晩)

晩		

Late, Evening.

This 漢字 also imparts the idea of late in a number of more poetic words—the first two compounds below offer examples.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	日 + 免
English	Sun/Clear + Exemption

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The late-evening ⌈sun⌋ was ⌈exempted⌋ from the rest of the ⌈day⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**バン (BAN)**	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Late ⟨**BUNNIES**⟩.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
晩秋	late + autumn = *late autumn*	バン·シュウ (BAN·SHŪ)
晩年	late + year = *one's later years*	バン·ネン (BAN·NEN)
今晩は	now + late = *"good evening"*	コン·バン·は (KON·BAN·wa)

{···} Sample Sentence

ブラウン	氏	は	晩年	に	入っている。
ブラウン	シ	は	バンネン	に	はいっている
Braun	Mr	は	last years	に	to get in

Mr Brown is in the sunset of his life.

漢字 21: Entwine (絡)

絡		

Entwine. Become entangled.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	糸 + 各
English	Thread + Each (**??**)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Entwine ⌈each⌋ ⌈thread⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**ラク (RAKU)**	**から (kara)**
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Entangled with ≺**caramel**≻ ⟨**LUCKILY**⟩.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
絡む	*entwine; become entangled*	から·む (kara·mu)
絡み付く	entwine + attach = *cling to; coil around*	から·み つ·く (kara·mi tsu·ku)
短絡	short + entwine = *short circuit*	タン·ラク (TAN·RAKU)

{···} Sample Sentence

此の	つる草	は	木	に	絡みつきます。
この	つるソウ	は	き	に	からみつきます
this	vine	は	tree	に	to twine around

This vine winds around trees.

漢字 22: Express (表)

表		

Express one's feelings and beliefs, etc.

This idea of bringing things into the open extends to this 漢字's other primary meanings, namely "surfaces and charts".

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	主 + 衣
English	Primary **??** + Clothing

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Express your feelings about the ⌈primary⌋ school's ⌈clothing⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**ヒョウ (HYŌ)**	**おもて、あらわ (omote, arawa)**

ヒョウ is the more common of these readings. あらわ forms the two verbs in the second and third examples below; you may recognize these as being pronounced identically to 現れる and 現す from Entry **??**. Not surprisingly, the pair here can also be seen written at times as 表われる and 表わす. Though these characters are similar in some respects, this 漢字 is used more for the idea of *expressing* things such as feelings, thoughts, and opinions.

L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Expressions of ⟨**YAWNING**⟩ when ≺**commotions**≻ go on in the ≺**Arawaks**≻.

‡Arawaks are indigenous people of South America.

+ Words and Compounds

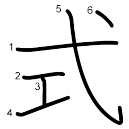
Example	English	Pronunciation
表	*surface; front*	おもて (omote)
表れる (intr.)	*be expressed*	あらわれる (arawa·reru)
表す (tr.)	*express; reveal*	あらわ·す (arawa·su)
表現	express + present = *expression*	ヒョウ·ゲン (HYŌ·GEN)

{···} Sample Sentence

思想	は	言葉	で	表現される。
シソウ	は	ことば	で	ヒョウゲンさせる
thought	は	words	で	expression

Thoughts are expressed by means of words.

漢字 23: Type (式)

式 

The primary meaning is that of a "type or style" of something (as in the second compound).

It is also very commonly used, however, in the sense of "ceremony" (as is evident in the final example).

Take care with the stroke order of this 漢字.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	弋 + 工
English	Shoot + Work/Craft

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Type of ⌈shooting ceremony⌋ for prosperous ⌈work and crafts⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**シキ (SHIKI)**	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Type of ⟨**SHEIKH**⟩.

‡Sheikh refers to a Muslim religious scholar.

+ Words and Compounds

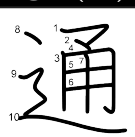
Example	English	Pronunciation
形式	form + type = *form; formality*	ケイ·シキ (KEI·SHIKI)
自動式	self + move + type = *automatic*	ジ·ドウ·シキ (JI·DŌ·SHIKI)
成人式	become + person + type = *Coming of Age ceremony*	セイ·ジン·セキ (SEI·JIN·SHIKI)

{···} Sample Sentence

朝食	は	バイキング	形式	だった。
チョウショク	は	バイキング	ケイシキ	だった
breakfast	は	smorgasbord	form	だった

Breakfast is a smorgasbord.

漢字 24: Passage (通)

通 

The general concept is of "passing through and along".

This is a very versatile 漢字 that can mean a variety of things, from "street" (it often appears on road signs), to the ideas of "thoroughly getting to know a subject" or "having things go according to plan".

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	マ + 用 + 辶
English	MA katakana + Utilize + Road/Walk

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Passage ⌈utilizes⌋ a ⌈road⌋ for ⌈mother⌋ to ⌈walk⌋ on.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**ツウ (TSŪ)**	**とお (tō)**
In the first position, ツウ is by far the more common reading. Both occur frequently in the second position, and the 訓読み is often voiced (although is never becomes so when forming verbs).		
L.C.	ツ (TSU)	かよ (kayo)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The passage to ⟨**TSUU'TINA**⟩ was ≺**tormenting**≻ because of the ⟨TSUNAMI⟩ ≺**knockout**≻.

‡Tsuu'Tina is an indigenous group in Alberta, Canada.

+ Words and Compounds

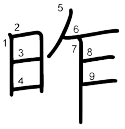
Example	English	Pronunciation
通る (intr.)	*go along; pass by*	とお·る (tō·ru)
通す (tr.)	*pierce; let through*	とお·す (tō·su)
大通り	large + passage = *a main street*	おお どお·り (ō dō·ri)
交通	mix + passage = *traffic; communication*	コウ·ツウ (KŌ·TSŪ)

{···} Sample Sentence

交通量	が	少なかった。
コウツウリョウ	が	すくなかった
traffic	が	few

There wasn't much traffic.

漢字 25: Past (昨)

昨		

Past.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	日 + 乍
English	Sun/Clear + Although/While

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The past , ⌈though⌋, is ⌈clear⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**サク (SAKU)**	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The past really ⟨**SUCKS**⟩ hey.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
昨年	past + year = *last year*	サク·ネン (SAKU·NEN)
昨夜	past + night = *last night*	サク·ヤ (SAKU·YA)
昨今	past + now = *recently; nowadays*	サッ·コン (SAK·KON)

**** Irregular Reading(s)**

Example	English	Pronunciation
昨日	past + sun (day) = *yesterday*	きのう (kinō)

This compound can also be read using the character's normal onyomi (サク·ジツ/SAKU·JITSU), giving the word a more formal tone.

{···} Sample Sentence

昨日	は	寒かった。
きのう	は	さむかった
yesterday	は	cold

It was cold yesterday.

漢字 26: Bundle (束)

束		

Bundle. Bunch.

Note that the writing order of this 漢字 does not follow the components as listed above, with "mouth" written after the initial horizontal stroke. It is similar in this respect to the character for *East* (東) from Entry **??**.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	木 + 口
English	Tree + Mouth

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Bunch of ⌈vampires⌋ forming bundles of ⌈wood⌋ from the ⌈tree⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**ソク (SOKU)**	**たば (taba)**
L.C.	—	つか (tsuka)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

A bundle of ≺tsukas≻ were sent to ≺**Thaba'NChu**≻ in a ⟨**SOCK**⟩.

‡Thaba'NChu is a town in Free State, South Africa.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
束	*bundle; bunch*	たば (taba)
花束	flower + bunch = *bouquet*	はな·たば (hana·taba)
結束	bind + bunch = *union; combination*	ケッ·ソク (KES·SOKU)

{···} Sample Sentence

約束	は	約束。
ヤクソク	は	ヤクソク
promise	は	promise

A promise is a promise.

漢字 27: Special (特)

特 | |

Special.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	牛 + 寺
English	Cow + Temple

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Special ⌈cow⌋ ⌈temples⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**トク (TOKU)**	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Special ⟨**TALK**⟩-shows.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
特別	special + different = *special; extraordinary*	トク·ベツ (TOKU·BETSU)
特売	special + sell = *bargain; special buy*	トク·バイ (TOKU·BAI)
特急	special + hasten = *special express (train)*	トク·キュウ (TOKU·KYŪ)

{···} Sample Sentence

特別	いい	気分	だ。
トクベツ	いい	キブン	だ
special	good	feeling	be / is

I feel just fine.

漢字 28: True (真)

真 | |

True. Genuine.

This 漢字 often intensifies the quality of the character that follows it. The irregular readings and the first compound below offer examples of this.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	十 + 具
English	Ten + Tool (**??**)

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

True ⌈cross⌋ ⌈tool⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**シン (SHIN)**	**ま (ma)**
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Truth ⟨**SHEENS**⟩ through the ≺**mucky**≻, ≺**muddy**≻ lies.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
真新しい	true + new = *brand-new*	ま　あたら·しい (ma atara·shii)
真実	true + actual = *truth; reality*	シン·ジツ (SHIN·JITSU)

**** Irregular Reading(s)**

Example	English	Pronunciation
真赤	true + red = *deep red*	まっ·か (mak·ka)
真青	true + blue = *deep blue*	まっ·さお (mas·sao)

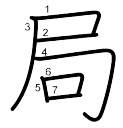
These are the only two words in which the readings of the 漢字 that follow 真 change in such a radical way. More common examples include 真白 (mas·shiro/まっ·しろ) *snow white* and 真暗 (mak·kura/まっ·くら) *pitch dark*. You may also see these compounds written as 真っ赤, 真っ青, 真っ白 and 真っ暗. Keep an eye out as well for a few words such as 真中 (まんなか/man·naka) *right in the middle*, which is also sometimes written as 真ん中.

{···} Sample Sentence

この	物語	は	真実	です。
この	ものがたり	は	シンジツ	です
this	story	は	truth	be/is

This story is true.

漢字 29: Office (局)

局		

Office. Bureau.

In a few words this 漢字 can also mean *the situation*, or *state of something* (the first compound is an example).

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	尸 + 口 + 勹
English	Corpse/Body + Mouth + Embrace/Wrap

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

The bureau of ⌈vampires⌋ ⌈partly wrapped⌋ the ⌈corpse bodies⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**キョク (KYOKU)**	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Office of ⟨**KYOKUSHIN**⟩ karate.

‡Kyokushin karate was founded in 1964 by Korean-Japanese Masutatsu Oyama.

+ Words and Compounds

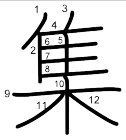
Example	English	Pronunciation
Recall from Entry **??** that the first two 漢字 of the second compound mean *water supply system* when taken together.		
結局	bind + office (situation) = *after all; in the long run*	ケッ·キョク (KEK·KYOKU)
水道局	water supply system + office = *water bureau*	スイ·ドウ·キョク (SUI·DŌ·KYOKU)
薬局	medicine + office = *pharmacy*	ヤッ·キョク (YAK·KYOKU)

{···} Sample Sentence

一番近い 薬局	は	どこ	に	あります	か。
イチバン ヤッ ちかい キョク	は	どこ	に	あります	か
closest pharmacy	は	where	に	to be	か

Where's the nearest drugstore?

漢字 30: Gather (集)

集		

Gather. Assemble.

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	隹 + 木
English	Old birds + Tree

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Gathering ⌈old birds⌋ in the ⌈tree⌋.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	**シュウ (SHŪ)**	**あつ (atsu)**
L.C.	—	つど (tsudo)

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Gather at the ≺**atsumori**≻ play with our ⟨**SHOES**⟩ on and ≺stew dough≻.

‡The Atsumori play focuses on a young samurai killed in the Genpei War.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
集まる (intr.)	*gather; come together*	あつ·まる (atsu·maru)
集める (tr.)	*gather; collect (sth.)*	あつ·める (atsu·meru)
集中	gather + middle = *concentration*	シュウ·チュウ (SHŪ·CHŪ)

{···} Sample Sentence

私	は	読書	に	集中した。
わたし	は	ドクショ	に	シュウチュウした
I	は	reading	に	concentrate

I was concentrating on reading.

Main Index of 漢字

A

All 皆 9

B

Bundle 束 15

C

China 漢 8
Climb 登 11
Command 令 3

D

Degree 度 4
Different 別 8

E

Edge 際 5
Entwine 絡 13
Express 表 13

F

Field 野 6
Flat 平 4

G

Garden 園 9
Gather 集 17

I

Immediate 即 10
Institution 院 11

L

Late 晩 12
Lend 貸 5

M

Measurement 尺 3

O

Office 局 17
Original 原 12

P

Passage 通 14
Past 昨 15

S

Shop 店 10
Special 特 16
Stone 石 7

T

Taste 味 6
True 真 16
Type 式 14

W

Wide 広 7

漢字 by Stroke Count

4 Strokes
尺 3

5 Strokes
令 3
平 4
広 7
石 7

6 Strokes
式 14

7 Strokes
別 8
即 10
局 17
束 15

8 Strokes
味 6
店 10
表 13

9 Strokes
度 4
昨 15
皆 9

10 Strokes
原 12
特 16
真 16
通 14
院 11

11 Strokes
野 6

12 Strokes
晩 12
登 11
絡 13
貸 5
集 17

13 Strokes
園 9
漢 8

14 Strokes
際 5